HEN

Written by

Kerry Ann Burke

Copyright (c) 2026

SECOND DRAFT (3 Sep 2026)

kerry.ann.burke.screenwriter@gmail.com
+353 089 218 0307

EXT. HIGH STREET - NIGHT

The stores are closed. The traffic nearly non-existent.

A teenage boy, JAMES, wearing a loose grey hoodie, is walking alone late at night. His shoulders slump. His gait is slow, but constant.

James turns and stops to look in at one of the few places still open at this late hour - a classic English pub.

INT. PUB - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS - THROUGH THE WINDOW

It is illuminated by the orange neon lights advertising various ales. It accentuates the warm tones of the pub's wood paneling.

At the center table are a bunch of ladies having a hen-do.

James stares through the window, tries to look away, but turns back and keeps staring.

The partiers are happy. Laughing. Smiling. Having drinks. Hugging. Crying in joy.

James stares longingly at the BRIDE-TO-BE (late 30s), a brunette woman already two sheets to the wind. She's wearing a white sash labeled "Bridezilla To Be" over flannel and jeans. The plastic tiara catches the light.

James's eyes wander from the tiara, to the sash, to the way the hair is tucked behind her ear. Then to the other women.

Fingers brush a shoulder.

A playful shove.

Someone absent-mindedly fixes another woman's hair.

Laughter collapses two friends into each other.

The bride tilts her head back for a shot.

Her tiara slips.

She absently straightens it.

Two of the women get up and dance with each other, in that girls-night-out devil-may-care way.

EXT. PUB - NIGHT

James, without music, without accompaniment, closes his eyes and dances like they do. A slight smile on his face. He loses himself, sighing.

INT. PUB - FANTASY - NIGHT

James is dancing now, inside. He finds himself in the middle of the group. One woman casually hands him the tiara. He places it on his head, for another woman to adjust it. Tears stream down his face as he laughs.

EXT. OUTSIDE PUB - NIGHT

A single tear rolls out of James' eye. Then he opens them.

The PUB LANDLORD is already staring at him through the window.

The landlord hastily draws the curtain shut.

Now the cold light from the street is brighter than the warm light inside, and James is left staring into his reflection. It's an ugly, twisted distortion from the age-old glass of the pub window. He turns away, unable to bear looking at it.

James starts walking away. Turns to take one look back. The pub is warm. The street is cold.

London drizzle gives way to full downpour.

James continues slowly, walking down the high street, slouched and slumped. He passes another pub.

This time he doesn't bother to look in the window.

THE END